

“Beyond the Breakroom” Branching Scenario

1) Scenario Charter

Lesson Title: Beyond the Breakroom.

Problem Statement (from the lesson’s Workplace Challenge)

A common workplace challenge is building trust amongst teammates and fostering a strong team connection. Without interpersonal connection, effective communication and collaboration cannot happen. When teammates don’t feel connected, communication breaks down, trust is slow to build, and we lose a sense of belonging—a challenge amplified in hybrid settings where spontaneous “water-cooler” interactions are reduced.

Learning Objectives (verbatim from the lesson)

Learners will be able to:

1. Reflect on their own experience interacting socially with their teammates.
2. Write casual conversation starters relevant to their workplace context.
3. Write a list of personal details they feel comfortable disclosing to teammates in social interactions.
4. Apply the 3 simple steps to building team connection and practice the dos and don’ts of workplace social interactions.

Intended Skills

- Self-awareness
- Social awareness
- Relationship-building skills

Framework

SPARK → **SHIFT** → **STRETCH** (awareness → language/perspective shift → real-world application).

3 Simple Steps to Building Team Connection (from the lesson)

1. **Open** — Use casual conversation openers to initiate connection.
2. **Disclose** — Offer small, appropriate self-disclosures within your comfort zone.
3. **Follow-up** — Show you remember; check back later to strengthen trust.

Success Signals (observable behaviors | used as subtle badges on screen)

- **OPEN:** Uses a context-appropriate **casual conversation starter**.
- **DISCLOSE:** Shares a **small, appropriate** personal detail within comfort/safety.
- **FOLLOW-UP: Remembers** and checks back later to show care.

- **DOs behaviors: Listen actively, respond with genuine interest, respect cultural backgrounds;** avoids DON'Ts (oversharing, dominating, interrupting, insensitive comments, stereotyping, exaggeration).

Context, Characters & What Happens (narrative spine)

- **Setting:** Global, **multicultural** team working **hybrid** (in-person + online). Focus: recreating **informal engagement** lost online (the “**water-cooler**” effect).
- **Protagonist: You, the Learner** (addressed in second person).
- **Colleagues:** **Rina** (primary), **Mateo** (optional), representing diverse regions/accents.
- **Narrative arc:** In the week leading up to a **cross-regional feature demo**, you navigate three everyday touchpoints—**virtual lobby**, **post-meeting chat**, and **later follow-up**—to rebuild trust using **Open** → **Disclose** → **Follow-up**, with **DOs/DON'Ts** and **intercultural notes** guiding micro-choices. Research flashes (Dinh 2021; McKinsey 2024; Zak 2017) appear briefly as lower-thirds.

Research beats to visualize

- **Dinh et al. (2021):** Informal proximity-based interactions accelerate trust; removing the physical environment removes unplanned engagement and can lead to **isolation** and weakened belonging.
- **McKinsey (2024):** **Trust** is a key factor in **team efficiency** and **results**.
- **Zak (HBR, 2017):** High-trust orgs report **less stress, more energy, higher productivity, fewer sick days, more engagement, higher life satisfaction, and less burnout**.

Logline

A multicultural hybrid team member learns how intentional micro-interactions—opening, small self-disclosures, and following up—rebuild trust and connection when “water-cooler” moments are missing.

2) Branching Structure (A/B/C) — Narrative Decisions with Consequence & Coaching

Important: Consequences **play in scene** (dialogue + reactions). Feedback appears as **coaching reflections** (no “correct/incorrect” labels). **Badges** (OPEN / DISCLOSE / FOLLOW-UP / DOs) pulse unobtrusively to signal observable behaviors.

Here’s the **branching structure (A/B/C)** exactly as set for the narrative storyboard—three decisions, each with options, in-scene consequences, and a short coaching note.

Situational Setup → Decision 1 (OPEN)

Context: Virtual standup lobby (morning). You and **Rina** join a minute early—tiny window to replace lost “water-cooler” moments.

Prompt: *What do you say to start connection?*

- **A — “How’s your day going so far?”**
Consequence: Warm, low-stakes opening; rapport breathes; culturally safe.
Coaching: Small openers help recreate informal touchpoints; rotate the approved starter list.
 - **B — “Did you finish that report yet?”**
Consequence: Transactional tone; rapport skipped.
Coaching: Add a brief human opener first; hybrid teams need intentional micro-connections.
 - **C — (Stay silent)**
Consequence: Awkward pause; missed micro-moment; distance grows.
Coaching: Silence reduces informal engagement; pick one safe starter to keep handy.
-

Situational Shift → Decision 2 (DISCLOSE)

Context: After the meeting. **Rina** mentions cooking with family—chance for small, safe reciprocity.

Prompt: *How do you respond to build trust?*

- **A — “Nice! I love cooking too... What did you make?”**
Consequence: Balanced sharing; curiosity; food/hobbies broadly safe.
Coaching: A little disclosure goes a long way—prepare a short “safe topics” list in advance.
 - **B — “Cool. I’ve travelled to 10 countries...” (long monologue)**
Consequence: Self-focused; oversharing risk; rapport stalls.
Coaching: Trim to one brief detail and ask one question back; avoid DON'Ts.
 - **C — “I don’t really talk about personal stuff at work.”**
Consequence: No reciprocity; connection cools.
Coaching: Pre-plan 3 safe topics (e.g., food, hobbies, places lived) to prevent awkwardness.
-

Situational Shift → Decision 3 (FOLLOW-UP)

Context: Later in the week (team chat). The demo is tomorrow; a thoughtful follow-up can cement trust loops.

Prompt: *How do you show you remember and care?*

- **A — “Hey—how did that dish turn out the other day?”**
Consequence: Specific memory + care; rapport deepens.
Coaching: Remembering & checking back strengthens trust over time.
 - **B — “Hope your week’s going okay.”**
Consequence: Polite; doesn’t deepen connection.
Coaching: Add one remembered detail to make it relational, not generic.
 - **C — “I need help with my project—free now?”**
Consequence: Transactional; warmth drops.
Coaching: Lead with relationship first; then make the request.
-

Badges (on-screen signals)

- **OPEN** (Step 1), **DISCLOSE** (Step 2), **FOLLOW-UP** (Step 3), **DOs** (active listening, genuine interest, respect).
 These **pulse unobtrusively** during the scene to signal the behavior shown—no “grading” labels on screen.
-

3) Linear Video Storyboard (Full Script + Camera Notes, with Cutaways)

(Narrative coaching style; includes conversation openers, navigation, badges, and cutaways. All examples, DOs/DON'Ts, reflection prompts are from the lesson.)

Legend for symbols on slides

- ★ **BEST** (most aligned with the lesson’s “3 Simple Steps” + DOs)
- ◇ **NEUTRAL** (partially aligned; missed cues)
- × **INCORRECT** (misaligned; risks trust/connection)
- ✓ **CORRECT** / △ **PARTIAL** / ✗ **INCORRECT** on feedback slides (requested format)

Cast

- **You (Learner)**
- **Sarah** (colleague; can be any culturally diverse persona)
- (Optional) **Mateo** appears in background in a couple of moments

Badges (on-screen, small and unobtrusive): OPEN, DISCLOSE, FOLLOW-UP, DOs

Where each step comes from in the lesson:

- **3 Simple Steps** (Open → Disclose → Follow-up)

- **Conversation starters** (Slide 8)
- **Self-disclosure examples** (Slides 11–14)
- **DOs/DON'Ts** (Slide 15)
- **Reflection prompts** (Slides 2, 10, 18)
- **Research flashes** (Dinh, McKinsey, Zak)

(All from the attached PDF.)

Slide 0 — Introduction (SPARK)

On-screen title: *Beyond the Breakroom*

VO (warm, concise):

“Welcome, Learner. In hybrid teams, we lose the unplanned ‘water-cooler’ moments that help trust grow. Small, intentional choices can bring that connection back.”

Lower-third flashes (very brief):

- *Informal interactions accelerate trust; losing the physical environment removes unplanned engagement and can lead to isolation.*
- *Trust is a key factor in team efficiency and results.*
- *High-trust workplaces: less stress, higher productivity, less burnout.*
(Pulled from the lesson’s research callouts.)

Navigation: Continue → Slide 1

Slide 1 — Decision Point 1: OPEN

Scene header: Virtual meeting **waiting room**, Monday morning.

Ambient: Calendar pings, keyboards, quiet office bed.

Action & Dialogue (watch first):

- **You** (joining early; camera on): “Morning.”
- **Sarah** (pops in, adjusts headset): “Hey—good morning.”
(Tiny beat—the moment you’d normally lose online.)

Prompt on screen:

*What do you say to **start** a casual, low-pressure connection? (Step 1: OPEN)*

Options (buttons):

- A. “How’s your day going so far?” (*conversation starter from the lesson*)
 - B. “Did you finish that report yet?”
 - C. (*You stay silent and check your email.*)
-

Slide 1A — You choose A. (★ BEST)

Play scene:

- **You:** “Hey, Sarah—**how’s your day going so far?**”
- **Sarah** (shoulders drop slightly): “Pretty good—early start with the APAC team. You?”
- **You:** “Doing alright—coffee’s helping.” (*shared smile*)
Badge pulse: OPEN ✓ • DOs ✓ (curiosity, genuine interest)

Cut-in coaching (2-3 lines, not a grade):

- Why this helps: *A simple opener replaces that lost informal beat and invites rapport in hybrid.*
- Try next time: *Rotate your starters—“What’s something good that happened this week?” or “How’s the project feeling on your end?” (Slide 8)*

Navigation: Continue → Slide 2

Slide 1B — You choose B. (◇ NEUTRAL)

Play scene:

- **You:** “Hey—**did you finish that report yet?**”
- **Sarah:** “Almost there—I’ll share after the standup.” (*tone flattens; micro-hesitation*)
Badge pulse: OPEN △ (transactional)

Cut-in coaching:

- What’s the risk: *You skipped rapport; in hybrid, we have to create those micro-connections on purpose.*
- Quick fix: *One line of human check-in before the task helps trust form.*

Navigation: Continue → Slide 2

Slide 1C — You choose C. (× INCORRECT)

Play scene:

- *(You glance down at email; Sarah checks her chat. The moment passes.)*
Badge: OPEN 🚫 (missed moment)

Cut-in coaching:

- Why it hurts: *Silence means the informal touchpoint disappears; that can increase distance and slow trust.*
- Try next time: *Keep one safe starter ready—"How's your day going so far?"*

Navigation: Continue → Slide 2

Slide 2 — Decision Point 2: DISCLOSE

Scene header: Right after the standup. Video ends, both of you linger a moment.

Ambient: Call disconnect chime; office background.

Action & Dialogue (watch first):

- **Sarah** (a little more relaxed now): "We tried a new **family recipe** this weekend."
- **You** (smile; considering your response).

Prompt on screen:

*How do you respond to build trust with a **small, appropriate** self-disclosure? (Step 2: DISCLOSE)*

Options:

- A. "Nice! I love cooking too—especially trying recipes from different places. What did you make?"
- B. "Cool—yeah, I've travelled to 10 countries and cooked amazing food everywhere..." *(you keep going)*
- C. "I don't really talk about personal stuff at work."
-

Slide 2A — You choose A. (★ BEST)

Play scene:

- **You:** "Nice—I love cooking too—especially trying recipes from different places. What did you make?"

- **Sarah** (lights up): “Dumplings—my grandmother’s recipe! We finally got the folds right.”
- **You**: “That’s awesome—sounds like a win.”
Badges: DISCLOSE ✓ • **DOs** ✓ (genuine interest, active listening)

Cut-in coaching:

- Why this helps: *A little disclosure + curiosity creates reciprocity and safety.*
- Prep list: *Food, hobbies, travel, cultural celebrations, places lived—with one second-level detail each. (Slides 11–14)*

Navigation: Continue → Slide 3

Slide 2B — You choose B. (◇ **NEUTRAL**)

Play scene:

- **You**: “Cool—yeah, I’ve **travelled to 10 countries** and cooked amazing food everywhere. The best was—” (*you keep talking*)
- **Sarah** (polite smile, glances aside): “Wow—sounds incredible.” (*energy drops a touch*)
Badge: DISCLOSE △ (dominates space)

Cut-in coaching:

- Risk: *It’s still disclosure, but it tilts self-focused—can feel like **oversharing**.*
- Try: *Share **one** small detail, then **ask one** question back.*

Navigation: Continue → Slide 3

Slide 2C — You choose C. (× **INCORRECT**)

Play scene:

- **You**: “I **don’t really talk** about personal stuff at work.”
- **Sarah**: “Oh—okay.” (*topic ends*)
Badge: DISCLOSE ⚡ (no reciprocity)

Cut-in coaching:

- Why it hurts: *Zero self-disclosure removes the chance to build rapport.*
- Low-risk path: *Use broader topics (food/hobbies) while staying in your comfort zone. (Slides 11–14)*

Navigation: Continue → Slide 2-CUT (short explainer)

Slide 2-CUT (10–12s) — Explainer Card

On-screen:

- “A little self-disclosure → stronger connection.”
- “High-trust teams: less stress, higher productivity, less burnout.”

VO (soft):

“Small, genuine details can help connection grow—over time, that shows up in how the team feels and performs.”

(Language drawn from the lesson’s research summaries.)

Navigation: Continue → Slide 3

Slide 3 — Decision Point 3: FOLLOW-UP

Scene header: Wednesday afternoon, team chat thread.

Ambient: Subtle UI ping.

Action & Dialogue (watch first):

- *(You notice Sarah is online. You remember the dumplings.)*
- **You** (typing cursor blinks...)

Prompt on screen:

*How do you show you **remember** and **care**? (Step 3: FOLLOW-UP)*

Options:

- A. “Hey—how did that dish turn out the other day?”
 - B. “Hope your week’s going okay.”
 - C. “Hey, I need help with my project—free now?”
-

Slide 3A — You choose A. (★ *BEST*)

Play scene (chat bubbles):

- **You:** “How did that dish turn out the other day?”
- **Sarah:** “It was great—my aunt loved it. Thanks for asking!”
- **You:** “Nice—glad it worked out.”

Badges: FOLLOW-UP  • DOs 

Cut-in coaching:

- Why this helps: *Remembering + checking back shows care and sustains trust.*
- Habit: *Make a quick note after a chat about one detail to revisit.*

Navigation: Continue → Slide 4 (SHIFT/reflect)

Slide 3B — You choose B. (◇ *NEUTRAL*)

Play scene:

- **You:** “Hope your week’s going okay.”
 - **Sarah:** “Thanks—you too!” (*short exchange*)
- Badge:** FOLLOW-UP △ (friendly but thin)

Cut-in coaching:

- What’s missing: *The remembered detail.*
- Try: *Add one specific reference to deepen the rapport next time.*

Navigation: Continue → Slide 4

Slide 3C — You choose C. (× *INCORRECT*)

Play scene:

- **You:** “I need help with my project—free now?”
 - **Sarah:** “Sorry—not right now. Prepping for the demo.”
- Badge:** FOLLOW-UP  (transactional)

Cut-in coaching:

- Why it hurts: *Leads with the ask; keeps the moment utilitarian.*
- Fix: *Relationship first—one brief follow-up, then the request.*

Navigation: Continue → Slide 4

Slide 4 — Research & Intercultural Note (SHIFT/reflect)

On-screen (short cards):

- *Trust grows through repeated positive interactions; losing physical proximity removes unplanned engagement and can lead to isolation.*
- *Trust is a key factor in team efficiency and results.*
- *High-trust workplaces: less stress, more energy, higher productivity, fewer sick days, more engagement, higher life satisfaction, less burnout.*
- *Intercultural lens: Some teams build trust via **interactions/character**; others via **competence/results**. **Comfort with self-disclosure varies**—start broad and pace depth. (All language condensed from the lesson slides and summaries.)*

Navigation: Continue → Slide 5 (Conclusion)

Slide 5 — Conclusion (STRETCH)

Checklist (from the lesson):

- **Open** with a casual starter (e.g., “How’s your day going so far?”).
- **Disclose** one small, safe detail—within your comfort zone (food, hobbies, travel, cultural celebrations, places lived).
- **Follow-up** later to show you remember and care.
- **Practice DOs; avoid DON’Ts** (listen actively, respond with interest, respect backgrounds; avoid oversharing, dominating, interrupting, insensitive comments, stereotyping, exaggeration).

Reflection prompts (Slides 2, 10, 18):

- *Were you in person or online? Who initiated? What did you speak about? What did you disclose? How did you feel? Did you follow up? What will you do differently next time?*

Final VO:

“Connection grows through small, genuine moments—one conversation at a time.”

Navigation: Finish (triggers SCORM completion logic in your Storyline block)

Implementation Notes (for your developer, not on-screen)

- **Keep it narrative:** You always **watch the scene first** (dialogue like “Hey, Sarah, how was your weekend?” “Great, I...”) and only then make the choice, with **coaching** instead of grades.
 - **Badges** (OPEN / DISCLOSE / FOLLOW-UP / DOs) pulse briefly when the behavior appears—no “Correct/Incorrect” labels.
 - **All content strictly from the lesson PDF:** 3 Simple Steps; conversation starters (Slide 8); self-disclosure examples (Slides 11–14); DOs/DON'Ts (Slide 15); reflection prompts (Slides 2, 10, 18); research summaries (Dinh 2021; McKinsey 2024; Zak 2017).
-

4) Final Takeaways Scene (single card)

- **Open** with a simple, inclusive starter (use **Slide 8** list).
 - **Disclose** one small, safe detail—within your comfort zone (use **Slides 11–14**).
 - **Follow-up** later to show you listened and care.
 - **Practice DOs; avoid DON'Ts** (Slide 15).
 - **Reflect & log** in your Journal (Slides 2, 10, 18).
 - **Trust outcomes:** Better communication, efficiency, and well-being (McKinsey 2024; Zak 2017).
-

5) Consequence Matrix (Quick Reference — narrative coaching)

Decision	Option	Consequence (summary)	Coaching — 1 line
OPEN	A — “How’s your day going so far?”	Warm, low-stakes start; rapport breathes; culturally safe.	Small openers replace lost “water-cooler” moments in hybrid.
	B — “Did you finish that report yet?”	Transactional; rapport skipped.	Add a brief opener first; hybrid teams need informal micro-touches.
	C — Say nothing	Awkward pause; missed micro-moment; distance.	Silence removes informal engagement opportunities and slows trust.

DISCLOSE	A — Small detail + curiosity	Balanced reciprocity; safe topic (food/hobbies); trust grows.	A little disclosure goes a long way—stay within comfort zone.
	B — Long monologue	Self-focused; oversharing risk; rapport stalls.	Trim to one detail and ask one question; avoid DON'Ts.
	C — “I don’t share at work.”	No reciprocity; connection cools.	Prepare 3 safe topics in advance to avoid shutdowns.
FOLLOW-UP	A — Reference the dish	Memory + care; rapport deepens.	Remembering & checking back strengthens trust loops.
	B — Generic check-in	Polite; no depth.	Add one remembered detail to make it relational.
	C — Request-first	Transactional; warmth drops.	Lead with relationship; then ask.

6) SCORM Variables + Scoring Logic (kept under the hood; experience stays narrative)

Implementation: Use a **Storyline 360** interactive-video block inside Rise 360 for variables/scoring/SCORM. UI shows **badges + coaching**, not grades. (Scoring per your spec: **A=10, B=5, C=0; Pass=20/30.**)

Variables (Storyline):

- `decision1_choice` (Text: “A”/“B”/“C”)
- `decision2_choice` (Text: “A”/“B”/“C”)
- `decision3_choice` (Text: “A”/“B”/“C”)
- `total_score` (Number; default 0)

Scoring:

- **A = 10, B = 5, C = 0 → max = 30.**
- **Passing Score: ≥ 20/30.**

Plain-English Logic:

- On each decision, set `decisionX_choice` and add `10/5/0` to `total_score`.
- On the final summary, if all **three decisions** are set and `total_score ≥ 20`, report **Passed/Completed**; else **Completed/Failed** or keep **Incomplete** per LMS policy.

JSON-like contract (for devs)

```
{
  "variables": {
    "decision1_choice": {"type":"string","values":["A","B","C"],"default":""},
    "decision2_choice": {"type":"string","values":["A","B","C"],"default":""},
    "decision3_choice": {"type":"string","values":["A","B","C"],"default":""},
    "total_score": {"type":"number","min":0,"max":30,"default":0}
  },
  "scoring_rules": {"A":10, "B":5, "C":0},
  "pass_threshold": 20,
  "completion_logic": {
    "all_decisions_made": true,
    "passed_when": "total_score >= 20"
  },
  "reporting": {
    "SCORM_1.2": {"score_raw":"cmi.core.score.raw","status":"cmi.core.lesson_status"},
    "SCORM_2004": {
      {"score_raw":"cmi.score.raw","success":"cmi.success_status","completion":"cmi.completion_status"}
    },
    "suspend_data": ["decision1_choice","decision2_choice","decision3_choice","total_score"]
  }
}
```

Completion Trigger

- **SCORM 1.2:** If all decisions set and `total_score ≥ 20` → `lesson_status="passed"`; else `"failed"` or `"incomplete"`.
- **SCORM 2004:** If all decisions set and `total_score ≥ 20` → `success_status="passed"`, `completion_status="completed"`.

Resume: Enabled (store variables in suspend data).

7) Developer Notes for Rise 360

Authoring Approach

- Build in **Storyline 360** as an **interactive-video** (decisions via time-based hotspots; **badges** as layers; **coaching** panels after each scene beat). Embed in **Rise** as a **Storyline block** for SCORM. (Rise’s native scenario doesn’t expose custom scoring variables.)

Recommended Rise Flow

1. **Text/Image blocks:** Intro + Workplace Challenge + brief research cards (Dinh, McKinsey, Zak).
2. **Storyline block:** The narrative interactive video (decisions, badges, coaching).
3. **Knowledge-check blocks (optional):** Non-scored recaps of DOs/DON'Ts and 3 Steps.
4. **Attachment blocks:** Downloadables—**Reflection Journal & Activity Log, Conversation Starter List, Self-Disclosure Planning Worksheet** (from Slides 2, 8, 11–14, 18).
5. **Accordion/Text blocks:** 3 Simple Steps; DOs/DON'Ts quick reference.

Accessibility & Inclusion

- **Open captions** on all video; strong **color contrast**; **keyboard-navigable** hotspots; descriptive **alt text**; **downloadable transcript**; globally accessible language (avoid idioms).

Visual/Audio Style

- Neutral brand palette; diverse casting/voices; ambient cues for micro-beats (chat pings, cursor blinks); **lower-third** research flashes (brief, non-lecture).

SCORM Export

- Export **SCORM 1.2** (or **2004** if your LMS prefers success/completion split). Track completion by **Storyline results** (`total_score`). Gate Rise progression with **Continue** block set to “Complete block above”.

References (as they should appear on a “Sources” card in Rise)

- Dinh, Julie V. et al. (2021). “Developing team trust: Leader insights for virtual settings.” (Quoted in lesson.)
- De Smet, Aaron et al. (2024). *Go, teams: When teams get healthier, the whole organization benefits* (McKinsey). (Summarized in lesson.)
- Zak, P. (2017). *The Neuroscience of Trust* (outcomes summarized via Abby Lewis’ HBR article in lesson).

FULL DECISION TREE (VISUAL FLOW)

START

↓

[D1: Start a Casual Conversation]

├— A (Best) → Warm rapport → D2

├— B (Partial) → Transactional → D2

└— C (Poor) → No connection → D2

[D2: Offer Self-Disclosure]

├— A (Best) → Balanced trust-building → D3

├— B (Partial) → Oversharing risk → D3

└— C (Poor) → Closes off connection → D3

[D3: Follow Up]

├— A (Best) → Strong trust signal → END

├— B (Partial) → Neutral connection → END

└— C (Poor) → Transactional → END

END → Reflection & 3 Simple Steps Recap